

ThreadWriter Quick Guide

For v0.12.3

ThreadWriter is a local-first editor for writing conversations, scripts, chat-style scenes, transcripts and dialogue-heavy drafts. It works on desktop and mobile, autosaves in your browser and can export your work in several portable formats.

1. Start writing

Choose a participant at the bottom of the screen, type in the message box and press **Enter** or tap **Send**.

- **Enter** — send/commit a message
- **Shift+Enter** — line break inside a message
- **Tab / Shift+Tab** — move between participants while composing
- **Ctrl/Cmd+Enter** — add a Narrative block
- **Ctrl/Cmd+Z** — Undo
- **Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+Z** or **Ctrl+Y** — Redo

Use *Narrative* for narration, stage directions, scene notes, system notices, time jumps or anything that does not belong to a speaker.

2. Set up your speakers

Open *Text* → *Participants* to add or edit participants.

Each participant can have a name, left/right alignment, bubble color, text color and optional avatar. Avatars can be an uploaded image, initials or an emoji.

Tap or click a message's ... menu to edit it, move it, insert something above or below it, change its speaker, add extras or delete it.

3. Choose how the conversation looks

Use the *Text* menu to change the presentation.

ThreadWriter includes four main styles:

Mobile Chat — colored message bubbles and optional avatars/tails

Transcript — clean speaker-and-dialogue layout

Theater Draft — stage-play style character cues and dialogue

Screen Draft — screenplay-like cues, dialogue, and action

You can also change the conversation width, background, header, participant colors and other presentation settings.

Avatars and bubble tails

In Mobile Chat, open *Text* → *Avatars & bubble tails*.

Avatars can appear only for each participant's first burst or persist throughout the conversation. They can sit above or alongside messages, use circle or square crops and display at several sizes. Bubble tails appear only at the end of a speaker's message burst.

4. Add detail when you need it

The ... menu on messages and Narrative blocks contains the extra tools rather than cluttering the main editor.

You can add *timestamps, annotations, images, image captions/alt text* and hand-built *faux link previews*. Images and previews are optional, so plain dialogue stays quick to write.

5. Import existing dialogue

Choose *File* → *Import* to bring in .txt or .docx material.

ThreadWriter can recognize common formatting including

- NAME: dialogue
- Alternating left and right-aligned Word dialogue
- Stage-play scripts with standalone character cues.

Always review the import preview before committing it. Anything ThreadWriter cannot confidently assign to a speaker becomes Narrative rather than being guessed.

Open is different: use it for ThreadWriter's own .threadwriter files.

6. Save, organize, and recover your work

ThreadWriter autosaves conversations locally in your browser. Use *Recent* to reopen them.

Use *Projects* to group several conversations or scenes together, reorder them, search across them and see a combined word count.

For portable copies, use *File* → *Save As* to create a .threadwriter file. Projects can also be backed up as .threadwriter-project files.

Undo/Redo protects your current editing session. *File* → *Version History* provides a small browser-local set of older snapshots. For anything important, keep portable backup files too.

7. Export finished work

ThreadWriter can export as:

HTML: For a self-contained styled conversation you can open in a browser|

PNG / JPEG / TIFF: For sharing or publishing the conversation as an image

Rich DOCX: Editable Word output that preserves much of the visual layout

Portable DOC: Cleaner, text-first manuscript transfer

TXT: Plain-text dialogue/transcript

Print / PDF: Clean printable output through your browser

Very long image exports can be split automatically into multiple pieces.

A couple of useful things to know:

ThreadWriter is local-first. Your browser's *Recent* list, *Version History*, and locally stored images are convenient

working storage, but clearing browser/site data can remove them. Use *Save As* or project backups for work you cannot afford to lose.

The app can be opened directly from index.html on desktop. When hosted over HTTP/HTTPS, such as on GitHub Pages, it can also behave as an installable/offline web app.